

4.4 The Final Cut

If you're not a movie buff and watch one only over the weekends or occasionally, then we'd suggest you just rig up the audio setup to your existing television or even your computer, provided you have at least a 17-inch monitor.

Think about it: do you really want a wide-screen TV and surround sound for those daily soaps? Someone in your household might, and thinking a little rationally will save you a lot of trouble. On the other hand, if movies are a daily diet and you have tonnes of cash to blow, then go ahead and splurge.

Go in for a 52-inch monster and blast the living daylights out of your neighbours with a 7.1-channel sound system.

For your first home theatre, though, we'd suggest you rein in your aspirations and play it safe. Go in for a mid-range system that would make sure the five-day test match and the latest Spielberg film are given their due.